LESSON 19

Future tenses 2.

Tenses referring to future: Future Simple (*will*-future), *be going to*, Future Continuous, Present Simple, Present Continuous

Future Continuous

We use the Future Continuous:

- to talk about activities which will be in progress at a certain time in the future

This time tomorrow they **will be** celebrat**ing** Peter's birthday.
Tomorrow I **will be** sleep**ing** all day.
He **will be** wait**ing** for you when you arrive.

- to talk about events which are very likely to happen because an arrangement has already been made

I **will be** giv**ing** a presentation soon.
She **will be** hold**ing** a meeting.
Next week we **will be** stay**ing** in this beautiful hotel.

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Formation rule: **will be + V-ing**

Laura **will be** read**ing** all day. / My friends **will be** wait**ing** for me.
Laura **will not be** (**won't be**) read**ing** all day. / My friends **will not be** (**won't be**) waiting for me.
Will Laura **be** read**ing** all day? / **Will** my friends **be** wait**ing** for me?

Affirmative

I You He/She/(It) We You They	will be ('ll be)	celebrating his birthday.

Negative

I You He/She/(It) We You They	will not be (won't be)	celebrating his birthday.

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Interrogative

Will	I you he/she/(it) we you they	be celebrating his birthday?

Present Simple and Present Continuous

We use the **Present Simple** when we talk about timetables, programmes etc. (for public transport, cinemas etc.)

My train **leaves** at 11.30, so I need to be at the station by 11.15.
What time **does** the film **begin** this evening?

We can use the form of the **Present Continuous** to refer to events which are *arranged* for the future. (e.g. We are taking our finals tomorrow morning.)

We **are** play**ing** tennis tomorrow at five.
I **am** see**ing** my dentist on Friday morning.
Eric and Julie **are** go**ing** to the theatre this evening.

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Compare:

Present Continuous: I'**m doing something** (tomorrow) = I have already decided and arranged to do it

A: What **are** you **doing** on Monday morning?
B: I'**m seeing** my dentist. (I have an appointment)

'be going to': **I'm going to do** something = I have already decided to do it; I intend to do it (but perhaps *not arranged* to do it)

A: **Are** you **going to watch** the late film on TV tonight?
B: No, I'**m going to have** an early night.

BUT: Do NOT use **will** to talk about what you have already *decided* or *arranged* to do!

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